

made an impact, as much philosophical as musical. He then visited Bayreuth, Germany, as a music critic at the inaugural Wagner Festival. His favorite Wagner opera was Lohengrin; its influence on his Swan Lake was immense. On the ballet's premiere in 1877, one critic deemed Tchaikovsky's score to be "too Wagnerian." Swan Lake built substantially on a little ballet that Tchaikovsky had devised some years earlier for the children of his sister, Alexandra Davydova. At her home, he could enjoy the family atmosphere that his own home lacked.



DIPLOMA CERTIFICATE, 1865

Tchaikovsky's diploma certificate from the St. Petersburg Conservatory, where he enrolled in 1862, under the directorship of Anton Rubinstein.